

without any guilt of not being good with my money". Once they had attained a control over the things they valued most and invested toward their big expenditures, living the Rich Life seemed easy.

Here are a couple of examples of my friends who massively conscious-spend but have no regrets over the way money is spent.

How Gopal can afford 3 bikes on a 30,000 salary

When he first told me that he was going to buy a Yamaha Yezdi as his 3rd bike, I choked and blurted, "ARE YOU INSANE?" (exactly what you'd have said too). He already had a vintage and also a KTM that consumed petrol like a thirsty cricketer on a dry summer day. When a group of friends and I questioned the logic behind the purchase he had nothing to say. In fact, he had pre-planned investments toward retirement with his company's provident funds and some more with index funds. To top it all, he had saved for buying the Yezdi by giving up on eating out for four months. On the surface, buying the Yezdi looked like a stupid decision, but was a result of pre-planned conscious spending.

How Monisha affords 15k worth make-up on a 45,000 salary

Monisha comes from a long family line of *'men go to work, women take care of the household'*. This meant, her father never expected her to work or provide anything for the family. And that left her to expend every inch of the salary she was earning. Upon graduating, she got into marketing at a top tier firm and that resulted in hanging out at Starbucks more often than she'd have liked. Being presentable was seen in her industry as a great way to position yourself and she started getting a taste for 2,000₹ lip garnishments. A couple of years later, her father asked Monisha to save toward her wedding. She agreed instantly, as up until then she wasn't saving anything and it seemed like a good idea. Then over-time, slowly, the saving request progressed to buying a flat in the city for her to live-in after marriage. She kept her head down and plodded along. Right now, 3 years later, she keeps up her expensive lifestyle with aplomb while simultaneously funding her father's demands in equal measure. Like many daddy's daughters, the moment her salary gets credited, she transfers 20,000 to her father who takes care of the saving/ investment part. Whatever remains, she spends as erratic as rainfall during a non-Monsoon month.